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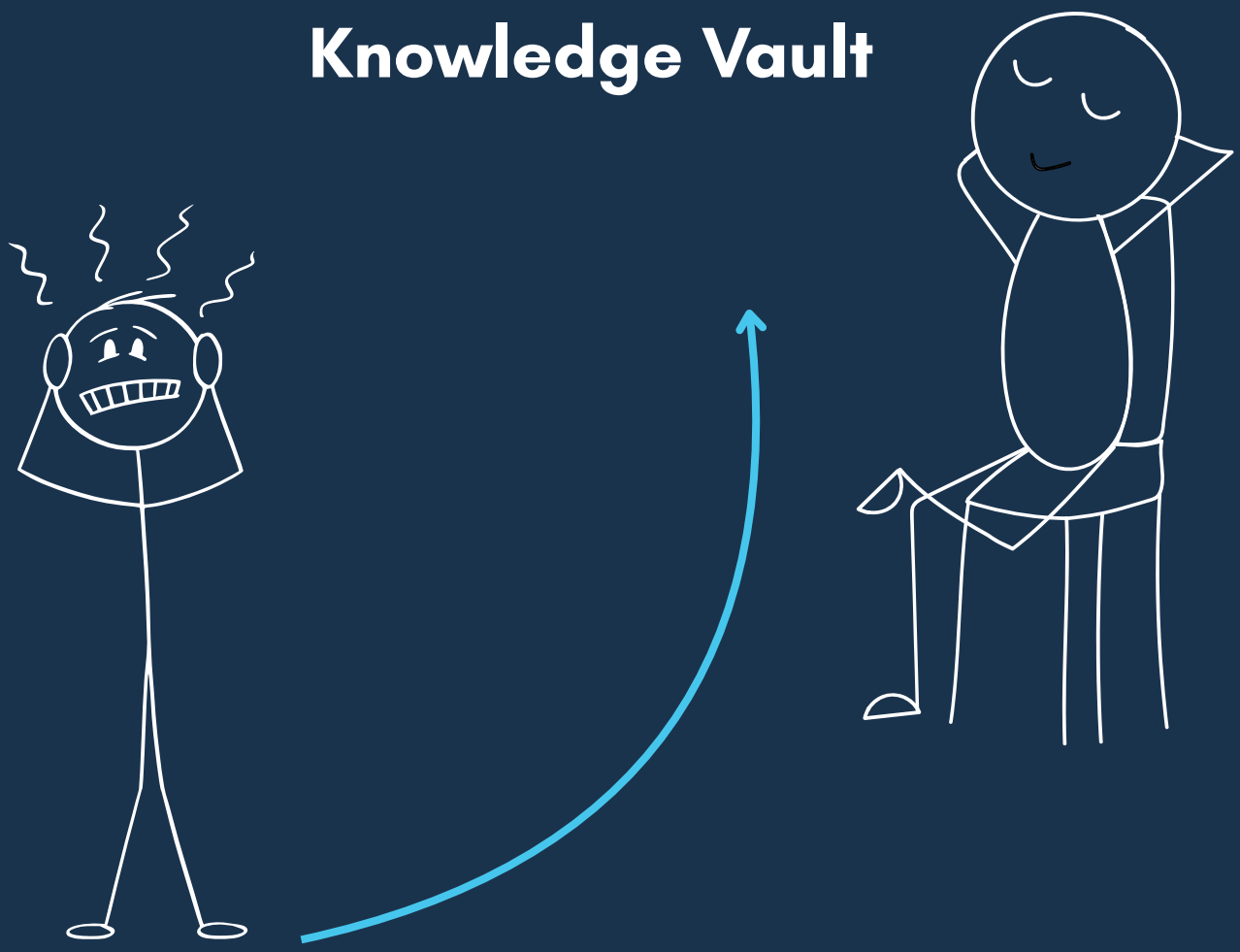
Stop the chaos. Start the control.

The Anti-Paralysis Protocol

Knowledge Vault



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Module 1

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

Understanding Your Hardware

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How Your Nervous System Works

WHAT IS IT?

Polyvagal Theory is a scientific theory developed by Dr. Stephen Porges that explains how our nervous system responds to stress, danger, and safety. It focuses on the vagus nerve, which plays a key role in regulating our body's automatic (autonomic) responses.

NEUROCEPTION

In polyvagal theory, neuroception is how our nervous system detects safety or danger in the moment. It draws from three sources: inside the body, the external environment, and interactions with others.

THE THREE STATES

According to polyvagal theory, the autonomic nervous system has three states:

- Immobilization: The “freeze” response—feeling numb, stuck, or shut down.
- Mobilization: The “fight or flight” response—activating the sympathetic nervous system.
- Social Engagement: A calm state where we feel safe, connected, and able to engage with others.

Understanding The Paralysis

WHAT IS IT?

The freeze response pauses movement while keeping the brain hypervigilant, waiting for fear to pass or deciding between fight or flight for safety.

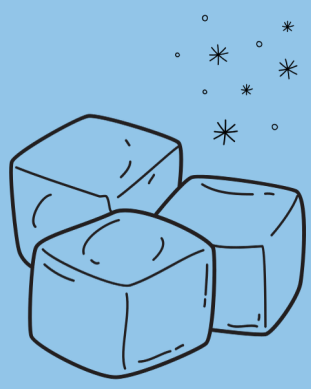
WHY DOES IT OCCUR?

The freeze response often stems from childhood trauma or conflict, especially in environments with high stress or abuse, where escape feels impossible.

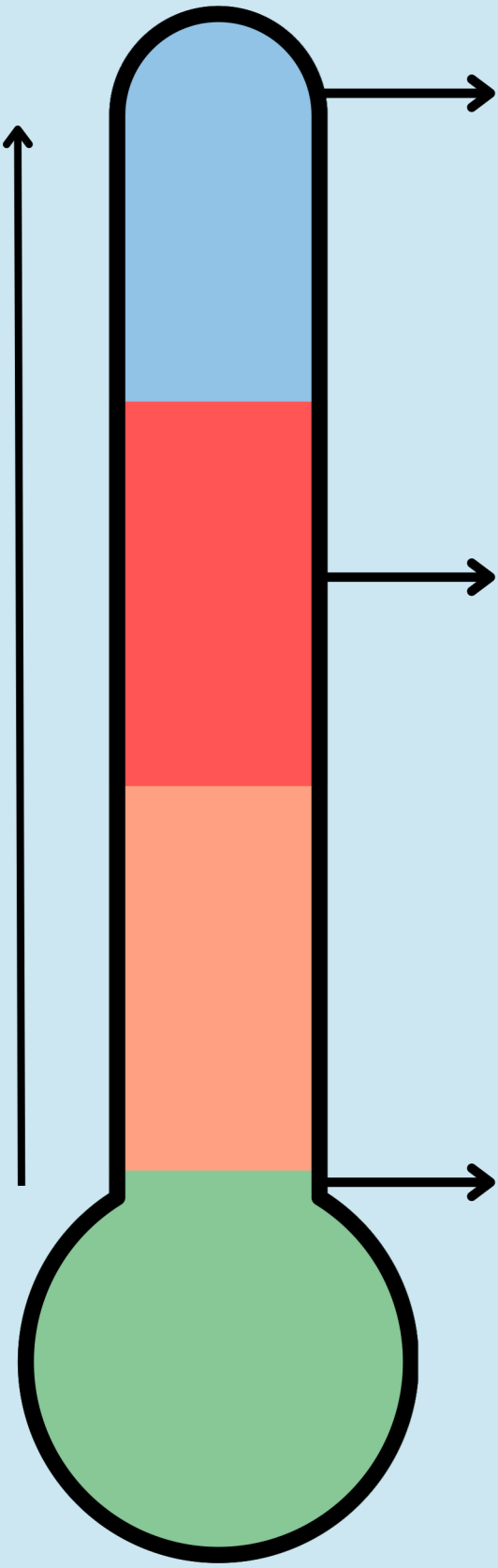
WHAT DOES FREEZING LOOK LIKE?

Common expressions of freezing may include:

Freezing can manifest as dread, stiffness, numbness, difficulty breathing, changes in heart rate, pale complexion, withdrawal, struggling to speak, and mentally disengaging from stressful situations.



Why You Freeze (The Traffic Light System)



DORSAL VAGAL

- “Freeze”, immobility response.
- Parasympathetic nervous system activated.
- Numbness, helplessness, feeling trapped.
- Feeling of overwhelm and a sense of “I can’t”.

SYMPATHETIC

- Either “flight” or “fight” response. Moving towards or away from danger.
- Sympathetic nervous system activated.
- Panic, fear, anxiety, worry.
- Rage, anger, frustration, irritation.
- Urge to act and a sense of “I can”.

VENTRAL VAGAL

- Social engagement.
- Parasympathetic nervous system activated.
- Connection, safety, being oriented to the environment.
- Joy, presence, mindfulness, openness.

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Module 2

SYSTEM BUGS & GLITCHES

Paralysis, Sabotage & The Inner Critic

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The Voice of Doubt

WHAT IS THE INNER CRITIC?

The inner critic is that internal voice that constantly judges, criticizes, and undermines us. It can be harsh, demanding, and even hostile, often making us feel inadequate or unworthy.

Everyone has an inner critic, but the intensity varies from person to person...

For some, this voice is so powerful that it can interfere with living a happy and meaningful life. It becomes a deeply ingrained pattern of negative thinking that distorts how we see ourselves, others, and the world around us.

When the inner critic gains too much influence, it can significantly impact our mental health, often leading to low self-esteem, diminished confidence, and persistent negative self-evaluation.

> *Once we learn to stop judging ourselves, we can look upon our lesser talents with compassion.* — Karen Rinaldi

Your inner critic distorts reality by judging you far more harshly than anyone else would—especially in areas where you feel vulnerable or inadequate. It exaggerates your flaws and weaknesses, making it difficult to see yourself accurately or with compassion.

Origins of Self-Sabotage

WHERE DOES MY INNER CRITIC COME FROM?

Our inner critic often begins to develop in childhood, shaped by our early experiences—usually without us even realizing it. It is commonly rooted in how our primary caregivers or other important figures spoke to us when we were young.

For instance, if you were frequently told that you weren't good enough, you may grow up with an inner voice that echoes the same message—constantly belittling you and reinforcing feelings of inadequacy. Over time, these external messages become internalized and form the basis of how we talk to ourselves.

In essence, the inner critic is a product of our early environment and relationships, and it deeply influences our self-perception and inner dialogue.

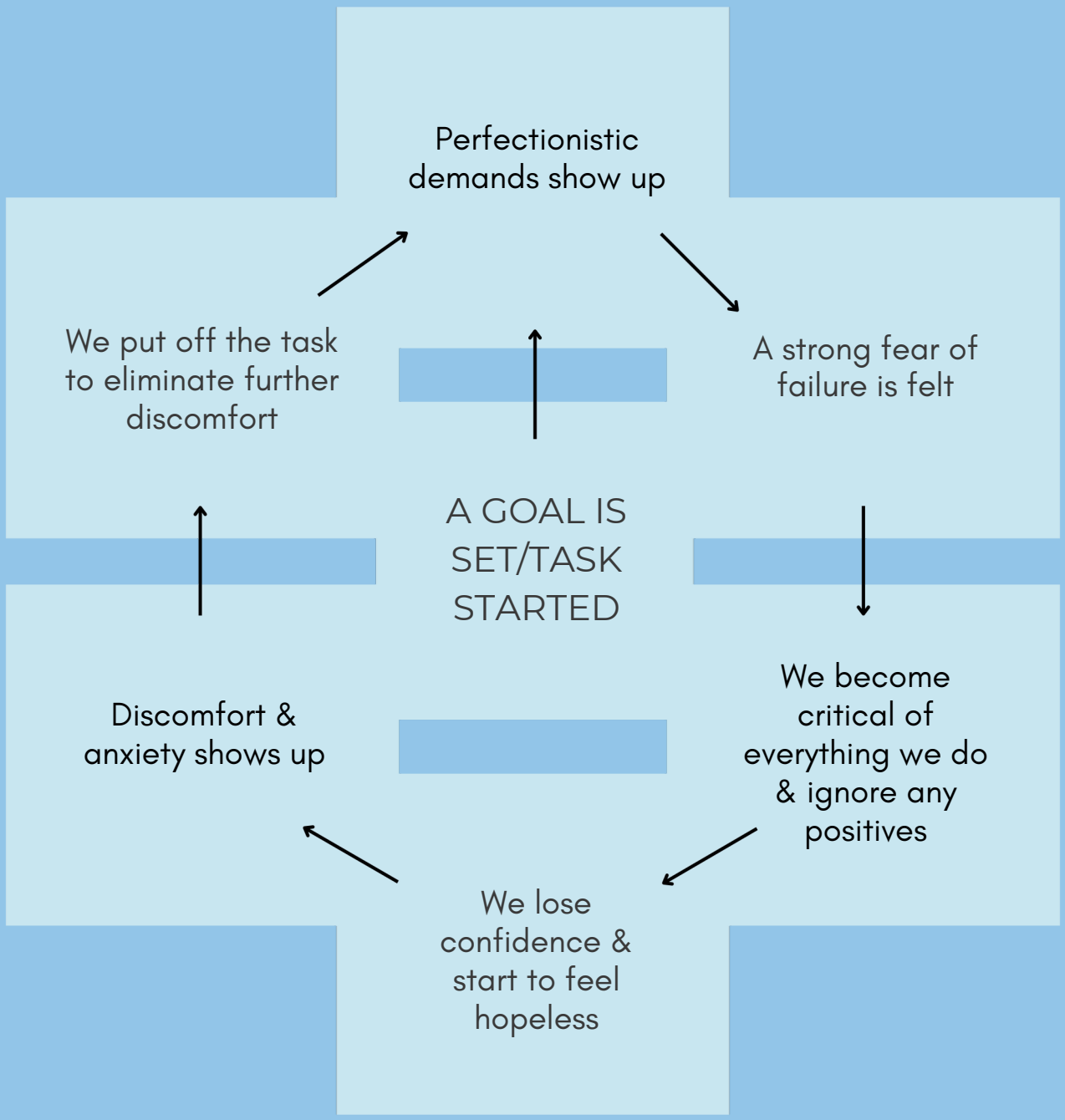
SILENCING MY INNER CRITIC

We've all faced criticism—some helpful, some not. Whether it was after a game, a performance, or a job interview, negative feedback can leave us feeling deflated and full of self-doubt.

While constructive criticism can help us grow, repeated negative remarks can stick with us. Over time, we may internalize those voices and turn them into our own harsh self-talk. So, how do we quiet that constant mental chatter...

THE SELF-SABOTAGE LOOP

Self-sabotage happens when we stop ourselves from reaching our goals or achieving success. The cycle of self-sabotage shows how we start a task or set a goal, but then end up abandoning it and choosing other activities or behaviours that don't help us.



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Analysis Paralysis

We know that the way we think affect how we feel. If you are feeling happy and excited, chances are, you have been thinking positive thoughts and about positive things. On the other hand, if you are feeling anxious, depressed, or upset, it is likely that you have been thinking negative thoughts. We call these unhelpful thoughts (simply because they lead to the experience of unpleasant feelings or unhelpful behaviours). All of us, at times, think things that make us feel sad or anxious, or that stops us from trying new things because we don't think we could handle it. This is a normal part of life, however, if you often feel distressed or anxious, you might need to examine your thinking to work on ways to improve how you feel.

If unhelpful thoughts lead to distressing emotions, then it might be quite reasonable to say that the most effective thing to do is to change those unhelpful thoughts to more helpful ones. So, how can you do that? To start influencing the way you feel, and to work on more productive and helpful behaviours you need to learn to be aware of those unhelpful thoughts and beliefs, with the ultimate aim of challenging and balancing them. To do that, let's start with doing an ABC analysis.

The ABC model describes how emotions and behaviour are a direct consequence of our thinking.

A - Activating event/situation B - Thoughts and Beliefs C - Consequences

A: The activating event can be anything - something that happens to us, something that somebody says or does, even something internal - an idea or memory that is triggered.

B: Can be beliefs or attitudes such as a 'real men don't get emotional', or they can be brief automatic thoughts such as 'I'm a failure' or 'I can't do this'. This also includes the constant chatter of negative self-talk that goes on in our head.

C: This includes anything that follows as a consequence of A and B (e.g. feelings, behaviours, and sensations). Examples include low mood, anxiety, anger and avoidant behaviour.

The Paralysis Loop (Why I Get Stuck)

Procrastination happens as a result of faulty assumptions, beliefs and rules around what we can expect of ourselves and the world. If we underestimate our ability to complete a task or reach a goal, or overestimate the discomfort associated with the task, we are much more likely to procrastinate completing the task then we are completing it. The procrastination cycle helps give us a clear view of the reason and function of procrastination. With some key tools, we can however interrupt the procrastination cycle, and instead move in to the "doing" cycle.

THE PROCRASTINATION CYCLE

APPROACH THE TASK/GOAL

UNHELPFUL RULES & ASSUMPTIONS ACTIVATED
This may include thoughts triggered by low confidence, fear of failure, fear of uncertainty or catastrophe, or simply being depleted of energy or seeking pleasure.

DISCOMFORT DRIVEN
The person detects discomfort in relation to the task/goal, detests the feeling of discomfort, and therefore the urge to dodge the discomfort builds. In response to this, the person will find excuses to procrastinate.

ENGAGES IN PROCRASTINATION ACTIVITIES

CONSEQUENCES OF PROCRASTINATION EXPERIENCED
Consequences can be both positive and negative.

CONTINUE TO PROCRASTINATE NEXT TIME

INSTEAD

THE DOING CYCLE

ADJUST UNHELPFUL RULES & ASSUMPTIONS
+
TOLERATE DISCOMFORT
+
DISMISS PROCRASTINATION EXCUSES

APPLY PRACTICAL STRATEGIES TO STOP PROCRASTINATING

CONSEQUENCES
The task gets done! A sense of achievement is experienced.

CONTINUE TO DO NEXT TIME, RATHER THAN PROCRASTINATE

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Module 3

RESOURCE MANAGEMENT

Rewiring Your Money Mindset

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The Scarcity Trap

WHAT IS IT?

A scarcity mindset is characterised by the belief that you have limited resources and/or that you are unable to provide for yourself or others. Scarcity can relate to different things, such as time, resources and money, however the underlying experience is an obsession with the lack of something to the point where it is difficult to focus on anything else or to make decisions for yourself.

WHY DOES IT OCCUR?

A scarcity mindset in relation to money can be developed due to a number of different reasons. It is however very common to develop a scarcity mindset if you have experienced financial stress or poverty while growing up, have experienced a sudden loss or change in financial circumstances (job loss, homelessness etc), or if you have grown up in a household where money and finances has always been a very stressful and negative topic.

WHAT DOES A SCARCITY MINDSET LOOK LIKE?

Common expressions of scarcity mindset may include:

- Feeling like there will never be enough money. Frequently
- catastrophising (for example thinking that one bad financial decision will lead to homelessness). Hoarding
- money. Struggling with tasks
- such as planning and organising.
- Delaying important things (such as booking in a health check up) in favour of saving money.
- Neglecting or experiencing strained relationships.
- Excessive worry around financial decisions.
- Difficulties with impulse control.

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Hidden Money Beliefs

WHAT ARE THEY?

Money scripts are typically unconscious beliefsthat wehold about money. These scripts are often developed in childhood and drive our adult financial behaviours. It is common for money scripts to be passed down through generations and are highly influenced by culture and socioeconomic circumstances.

HOW DO THEY IMPACT US?

The money scriptswe holdcan have a significant impacton ourrelationship with and behaviour around money. There are four key categories of money scripts, and research indicates that three of these categories (money avoidance, money worship and money status) of beliefs are correlated with poorer financial health, increased financial worry and risk taking behaviours around money.

THE 4 CATEGORIES OF MONEY SCRIPTS

MONEY AVOIDANCE

The belief that money is bad. People with this belief often think that rich people are greedy, and may believe that they don't deserve money.

MONEY WORSHIP

The belief that more money will be the solution to all problems, that there will never be enough money, and that money brings power and happiness

MONEY STATUS

The belief that money equates to status in life. A person with this belief will often have their self-worth closely tied with their net worth and possessions.

MONEY VIGILANCE

The belief that money should be treated with caution, that it is important to save for emergencies, and that you should be discreet around your finances.

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Rewriting Your Money Story

How we feel about money is highly uncorrelated with how much money we actually have in the bank. Instead, how we feel about and behave in relation to money has a lot to do with how we have grown up around money, as well as our emotional responses and fears. Take a moment to reflect on your money story, and how this has shaped your relationship with money.

WHAT WAS MY FAMILY'S RELATIONSHIP WITH MONEY GROWING UP? HOW DID THAT EFFECT ME?

WHAT EMOTIONAL TRIGGERS CAUSE ME TO EITHER HOARD MONEY OR SPEND IRRESPONSIBLY?

WHAT ARE MY DEEPEST FEARS AROUND MONEY?

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WHAT HAS HINDERED ME FROM MASTERING AND FEELING COMFORTABLE AROUND MONEY?

WHAT ARE MY EXCUSES FOR NOT LEARNING ABOUT MONEY MANAGEMENT OR AVOIDING DEALING WITH FINANCES ALL TOGETHER?

WHAT ARE THE TOP 5 THINGS I WOULD LIKE TO CHANGE AROUND HOW I RELATE TO AND BEHAVE AROUND MONEY?

Smart Spending vs Fear Spending

Money management isn't about being 'cheap'. It's about the operating system running in your background. Your brain has two financial modes: one runs on Fear (Scarcity), and the other runs on Strategy (Smart). Learning to switch modes is the key to financial freedom.

FEAR SPENDING	***SMART SPENDING***
Often driven by emotion	Often driven by logic and planning
Considers only cost when purchasing	Considers both cost and quality in their purchases
Will save money no matter the expense to them or others	Invests in high-value tools
Is often reactive and avoidant	Considers pros and cons of purchases and plans ahead
Focuses on Cost, not Value	Prioritising what to spend money on to maximise value
Generally make day-to-day or situation-to-situation decisions	Has a clear long-term vision for their finances

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Module 4

MAINTENANCE PROTOCOLS

Energy Regulation & System Resets

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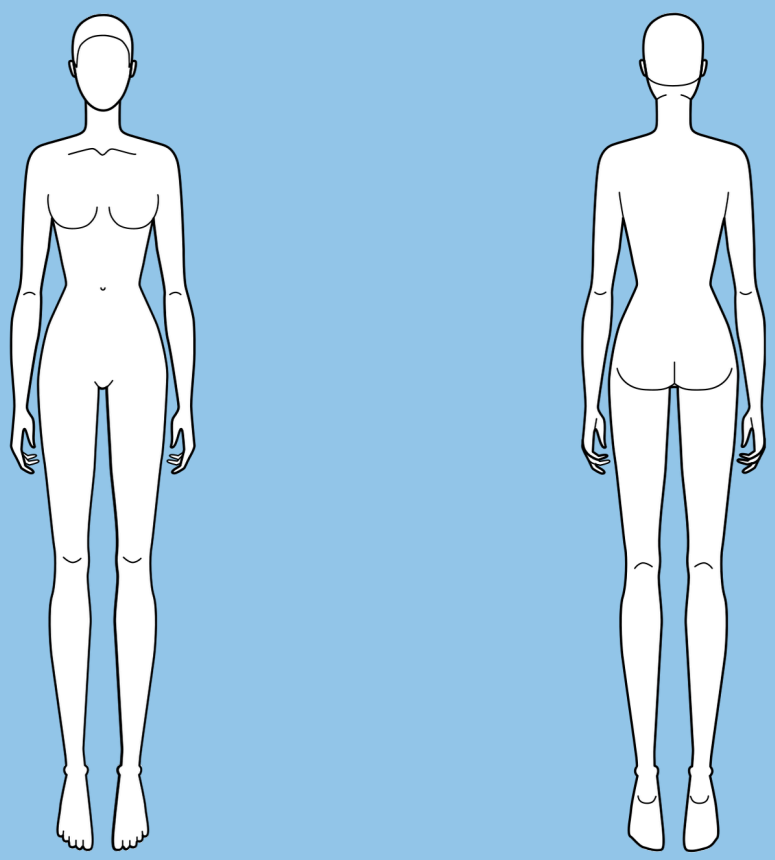
Your Energy Zones

Energy Monitor is the ability to move between tension and calm in the body. A resilient nervous system shifts between these states without getting stuck. Start by identifying where you feel most activated and most calm, and use color codes if helpful.



HIGH ACTIVITY ***MEDIUM ACTIVITY*** ***LOW ACTIVITY***

NEUTRAL ***CALM***

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Body Scan Protocol

Sit comfortably in a quiet space. Feel your feet on the ground and your hands resting on your lap or belly. Adjust your posture until you feel supported. Then, use your senses to connect with something pleasant around you:

- Notice the colors, shapes, light, and shadows around you.
- Listen to nearby and distant sounds.
- Feel the textures of your clothes, chair, or the floor under your feet.
- Take in any scents in the room.

Use your internal senses to connect with a pleasant sensation internally:

- Notice your relaxed muscles.
- Feel the gentle rhythm of your breath.
- Sense the warmth and comfort in your body.

Draw your attention to each of those sensations for a few moments each time, and pay attention to the shift in emotional and physical sensations.

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Quick System Resets

WHY REGULATE?

Polyvagal theory suggests certain activities can help relax and strengthen the vagus nerve, making it easier for your body to return to calm after stress. See below for simple ways to support this.

EXERCISES

Below are some simple strategies you can engage in to help you regulate emotions and connect with the social engagement stage.

TO CONNECT WITH THE PRESENT:

- Balance a pen on your finger.
- Hold on to a smooth object.
- Hold a warm cup of tea or coffee.
- Smell essential oils.
- Wash your hands in warm water.
- Listen to music.
- Take a walk in nature.
- Self-massage.

WHEN FEELING DYSREGULATED:

- Splash cold water on your face.
- Engage in deep breathing.
- Splash cold water on wrists.
- Stretch.
- Listen to high-energy music.
- Use a pen, hold it in front of your face in line with your eyes. Slowly move the pen back and forth in front of your face while tracking the movement with your eyes.

Muscle Tension Release

One method of reducing muscle tension and relieving physical symptoms of stress or overwhelm is a technique called Progressive Muscle Relaxation (PMR). Follow the steps below to complete the exercise.

Sit in a quiet spot, close your eyes, and take five deep breaths.

Focus on one muscle group, tense it for about five seconds while inhaling, then fully relax it as you exhale.

Notice the difference between tension and relaxation.

Rest for 15 seconds, then move to the next muscle group.

Repeat the process, and enjoy the full-body relaxation at the end.

RECOMMENDED MUSCLE GROUP SEQUENCE

- Right foot
- Right lower leg and foot
- Entire right leg
- Left foot
- Left lower leg and foot
- Entire left leg
- Right hand
- Right forearm and hand
- Entire right arm
- Left hand
- Left forearm and hand
- Entire left arm
- Abdomen
- Chest
- Neck and shoulders
- Face

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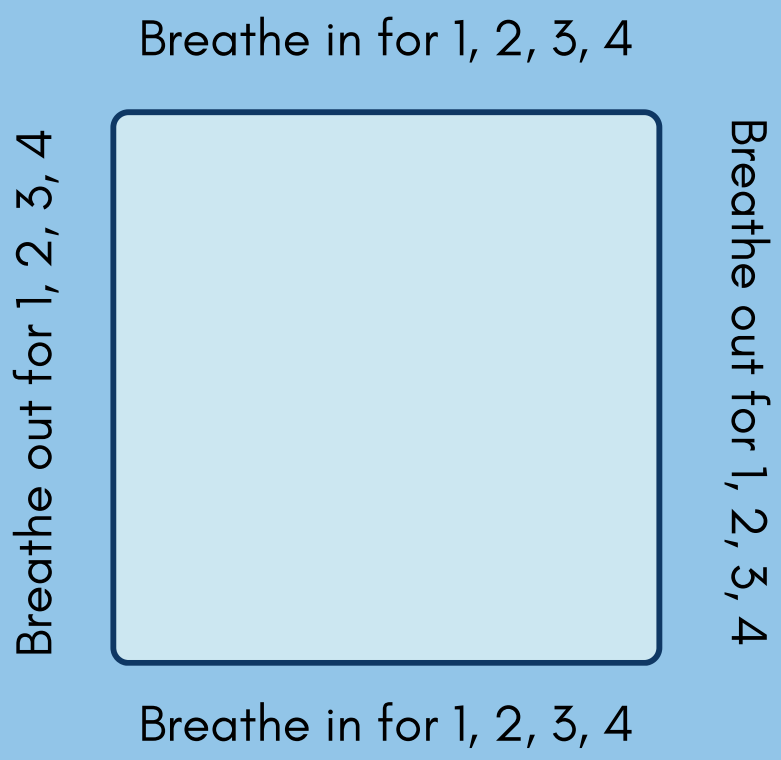
Tactical Breathing



- Breathe in for 4 seconds while tracing one side of the box.
- Then breathe out for 4 seconds, while tracing the next side of the box.
- Once again, breathe in for 4.
- And out for 4 while tracing the last side of the box.

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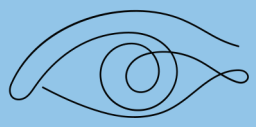
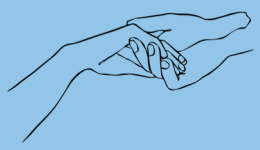
Reality Check

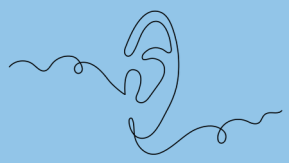
Focusing on identifying...



5 THINGS YOU CAN SEE



4 THINGS YOU CAN TOUCH



3 THINGS YOU CAN HEAR

2 THINGS YOU CAN SMELL

1 THING YOU CAN TASTE

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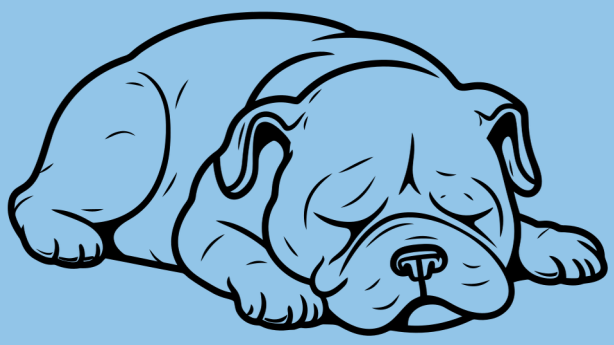
SLEEP HYGIENE

Sleep is essential for mental health. While needs vary, 7-9 hours is commonly recommended. Poor sleep can raise anxiety, lower mood, and affect focus, mood, and judgment. Struggling with sleep?
Try the tips below to help improve it.

- Here's a shortened version of your dot points:
- Stick to a routine: Go to bed and wake up at the same time daily, even on weekends.
- Sleep when tired: Only go to bed when you feel sleepy.
- Get up if needed: If you can't sleep after 15-20 minutes, do something calming, then try again.
- Track your sleep: Use a sleep diary to spot helpful or harmful habits.
- Bed = sleep: Use your bed only for sleep and intimacy to build a strong sleep association.
- Skip naps: Avoid daytime naps to stay tired at bedtime.
- Create a routine: Do calming activities before bed like stretching, breathing, or a warm shower.
- Avoid clock-watching: Checking the time can keep you awake and increase stress.
- Make it comfy: Keep your room cool, dark, and quiet for better sleep.



Notes

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This workbook gives you the tools. But NaviMind App will give you the Accountability.

We are building the world's first AI Mentor that ensures you actually do what you planned.

Be the first to access the future of focus.

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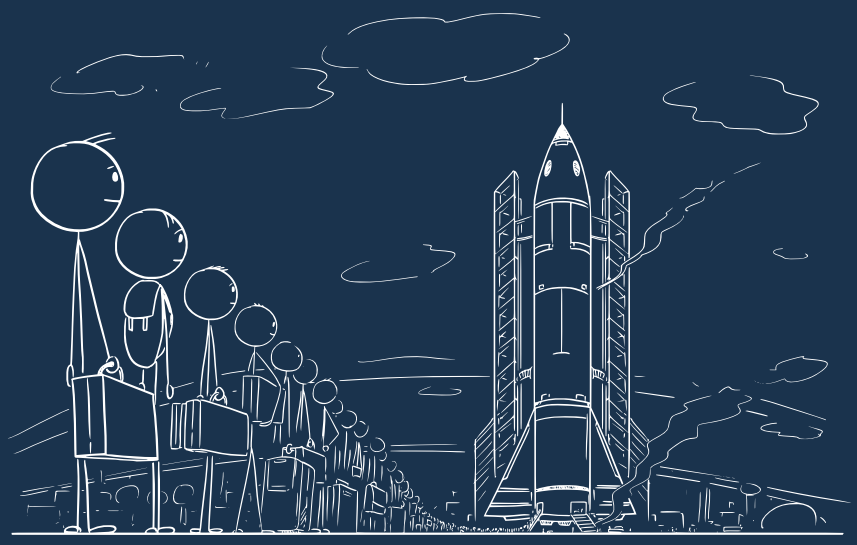

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